الجمعة عند تيتا

ij-jum3a 3ind Teta

Friday at Grandma's



اللهجة الفلسطينية — القدس

Spoken Palestinian (Jerusalem). No fus7a, no tashkeel.

Before you start

This one is about family, food, and an old man remembering. It is where you meet the **past tense** properly, plus the trick for saying "we used to".

THE CHAT ALPHABET

7	ح	hard breathy H
5	خ	kh
3	ع	ayn
2	ء ق	glottal stop — and ق is a glottal stop in Jerusalem
gh	غ	French-style r

THE FAMILY, THE WAY PEOPLE ACTUALLY SAY IT

تيتا	*Teta*	grandma (not جدة)
سيدو	*Seedo*	grandpa (not جد)
إمي	*immi*	my mum · ماما maama
أبوي	*abouy*	my dad · بابا baaba
أخوي	*a5ouy*	my brother · أختي u5ti my sister
عمي / عمتي	*3ammi / 3ammti*	dad's brother / dad's sister
خالي / خالتي	*5aali / 5aalti*	mum's brother / mum's sister
العيلة	*il-3eele*	the family
الولاد	*il-wlaad*	the kids

The lovely bit. A grandparent calls the grandchild by their *own* title: سيدو says تعال يا جدي *ta3aal ya jiddi* — literally "come, my grandfather" — meaning "come here, my boy". Same with يا ماما from a mother to her child. It sounds backwards and it is completely normal.

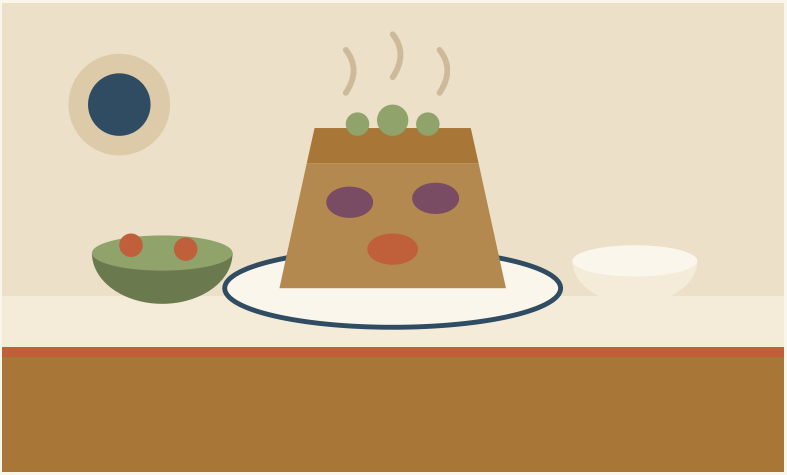


كل جمعة، عيلة سامي بتروح عند تيتا في بيت حنينا.
تيتا بتفتح الباب وبتقول:
«يا هلا! يا هلا! تفضلوا!»

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kill jum3a, 3eelit Saami btrou7 3ind Teta fee Beet 7aneena.
Teta btifta7 il-baab w-bit2oul:
“ya hala! ya hala! tfaddalu!”

Every Friday, Sami's family goes to Grandma's in Beit Hanina. Grandma opens the door and says: “Welcome! Welcome! Come in!”



ريحة المقلوبة بتملا البيت كله.

تيتا بتقول:

«اليوم عملتلكم مقلوبة، وسلطة، وشوية لبن.»

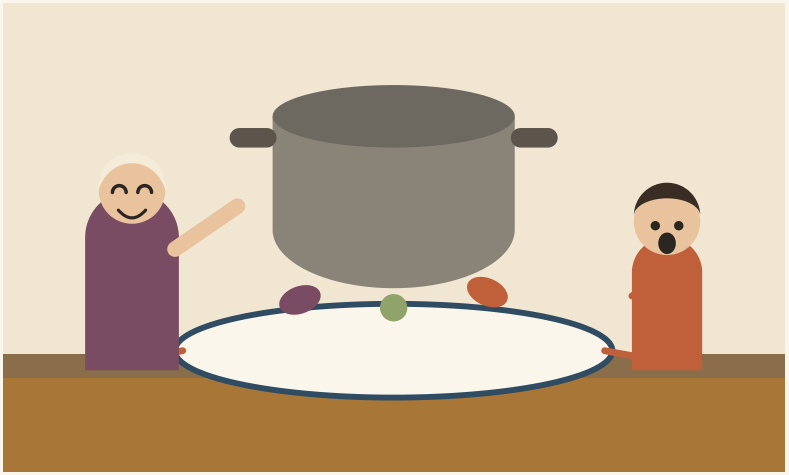
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ree7it il-ma2loube btimla il-beet killo.

Teta bit2oul:

“il-yom 3amaltilkom ma2loube, w-salata, w-shwayyit laban.”

The smell of maqluba fills the whole house. Grandma says: “Today I've made you maqluba, salad, and a bit of yoghurt.”



«تيتا، ليش اسمها مقلوبة؟»

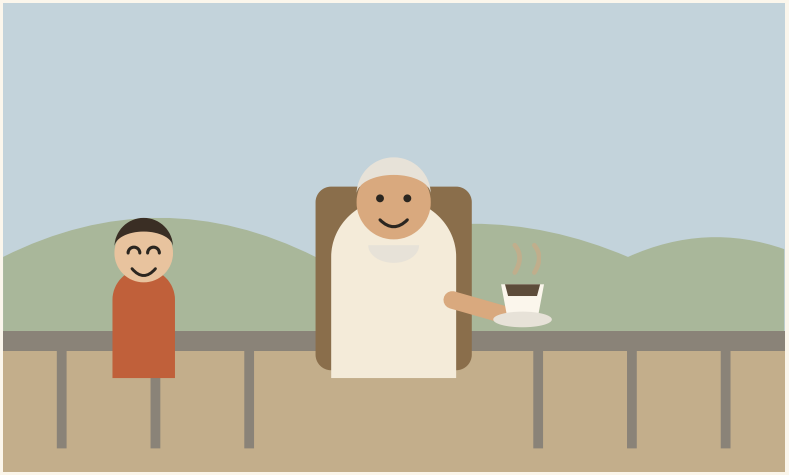
تيتا بتضحك وبتقول:

«لأنه منقلبها عالطبق يا سيدي! شوف!»

وبتقلب الطنجرة... طاخ!

"Teta, leesh ismha ma2loube?"
Teta btid7ak w-bit2oul:
"la2inno mnu2libha 3at-taba2 ya seedi! shouf!"
w-bti2leb it-tanjara... taa5!

"Grandma, why is it called *maqluba*?" Grandma laughs and says: "Because we flip it over onto the plate, my dear! Watch!" And she flips the pot... thud!



بعد الأكل، سيدو بيقعد عالبلكونة وبيشرب قهوة.
بيقول لسامي:
«تعال يا جدي، خليني احكيلك حكاية من زمان.»

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ba3d il-akel, Seedo byi23od 3al-balkone w-byishrab 2ahwe.
bi2oul la-Saami:
“ta3aal ya jiddi, 5alleeni a7keelak 7ikaaye min zamaan.”

After the meal, Grandpa sits out on the balcony and drinks coffee. He says to Sami: “Come here, my boy, let me tell you a story from the old days.”



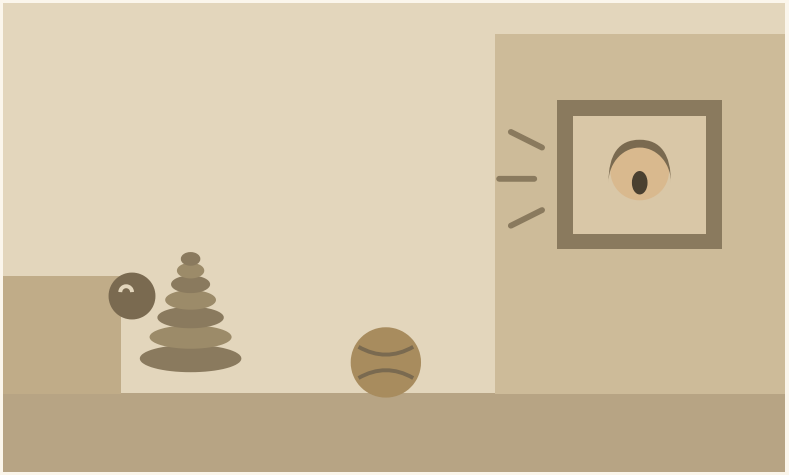
«لما كنت زغير، ما كان في تلفزيون ولا موبايل.
كنا نلعب بالحارة لحد ما تصير الدنيا عتمة.»

سامي بيسأل:

«وشو كنتوا تلعبوا؟»

"lamma kunt zgheer, maa kaan fee television wala mobile.
kunna nil3ab bil-7aara la7ad ma tseer id-dinya 3atme."
Saami byis2al: "w-shou kuntu til3abu?"

"When I was little, there was no TV and no mobile. We used to play out in the neighbourhood until it went dark." Sami asks: "And what did you use to play?"



«كنا نلعب غميضة، وسبع حجار، وكرة.
وإمي كانت تنادي من الشباك:
يلا عالبيت! تأخرتوا!»

“kunna nil3ab ghmeeda, w-sab3 7jaar, w-koora.
w-immi kaanat tnaadi min ish-shibbaak:
yalla 3al-beet! t2a55artu!”

“We used to play hide-and-seek, seven stones, and football. And my mother would call from the window: Come on, get home! You're late!”



عالليل، وهم راجعين عالبيت، سامي قال لأبوه:

«بابا، بدي أروح عند تيتا كل يوم، مش بس يوم الجمعة.»

أبوه ضحك وقال:

«وبعدين مين رح يوكل المقلوبة كلها؟ إنت؟»

3al-leel, w-humme raj3een 3al-beet, Saami 2aal la-abou:
"baaba, biddi arou7 3ind Teta kill yom, mish bass yom ij-jum3a."
abou di7ik w-2aal:
"w-ba3deen meen ra7 yokel il-ma2loube killha? inte?"

At night, on their way home, Sami said to his dad: "Dad, I want to go to Grandma's every day, not just on Friday." His dad laughed and said: "And then who's going to eat that whole maqluba? You?"

Words from this story

Food, family, and the language of remembering.

كل جمعة	*kill jum3a*	every Friday · الجمعة also = the week
عيلة	*3eele*	family
بيت حنينا	*Beet 7aneena*	a Jerusalem neighbourhood
يا هلا	*ya hala*	welcome! · also أهلين ahlein
تفضلوا	*tfaddalu*	come in / help yourselves / after you
بتملا	*btimla*	it fills · ملا mala to fill
كله	*killo*	all of it · كلها killha all of it (f.)
مقلوبة	*ma2loube*	"upside-down" — rice, aubergine and meat
عملتلكم	*3amaltilkom*	I made for you (pl.)
سلطة	*salata*	salad
شوية	*shwayye*	a little, a bit of
لبن	*laban*	yoghurt (in the Levant — *not* milk)
حليب	*7aleeb*	milk — this is the word you want
ليش	*leesh*	why · لأنه la2inno because
منقلبها	*mnu2libha*	we flip it · قلب 2alab to turn over

Words from this story · continued

الطبق	*it-taba2*	the plate, the dish
يا سيدي	*ya seedi*	affectionate "my dear" (to a child or a friend)
الطنجرة	*it-tanjara*	the cooking pot
طاخ	*taa5*	thud! bang! (sound word)
بعد الأكل	*ba3d il-akel*	after the meal · الأكل = food
بيقعد	*byi23od*	he sits (not يجلس)
البلكونة	*il-balkone*	the balcony
قهوة	*2ahwe*	coffee · also = a café
خليني	*5alleeni*	let me · خليك 5alleek stay / keep
احكيلك	*a7keelak*	I'll tell you
حكاية	*7ikaaye*	a story, a tale
من زمان	*min zamaan*	from long ago · also "for ages"
لما	*lamma*	when (in a statement, never a question)
زغير	*zgheer*	small, young · كبير kbeer big, old
ولا	*wala*	nor, not even

Words from this story · continued

كنا نلعب	*kunna nil3ab*	we used to play
الحارة	*il-7aara*	the neighbourhood, the lane
لحد ما	*la7ad ma*	until (+ verb)
تصير	*tseer*	it becomes · صار saar became, happened
عتمة	*3atme*	darkness · الدنيا عتمة it's dark out
غميضة	*ghmeeda*	hide-and-seek
سبع حجار	*sab3 7jaar*	"seven stones" — the classic street game
كرة	*koora*	ball, football
تنادي	*tnaadi*	she calls out
تأخرتوا	*t2a55artu*	you (pl.) are late
عالليل	*3al-leel*	at night · بالنهار bin-nhaar by day
راجعين	*raj3een*	going back (pl.)
مش بس	*mish bass*	not only
وبعدين	*w-ba3deen*	"and then?" — also "so what?"
يوكل	*yokel*	he eats · أكل akal he ate

Dialect notes

The past tense, and the one construction that lets you talk about your childhood.

1 · PAST TENSE ENDINGS

Take the bare past stem — لعب *li3ib*, he played — and add:

لعبت	*li3ibt*	I played / you (m.) played
لعبتي	*li3ibti*	you (f.) played
لعب	*li3ib*	he played
لعبت	*li3bat*	she played
لعبنا	*li3ibna*	we played
لعبتوا	*li3ibtu*	you (pl.) played
لعبوا	*li3bu*	they played

No بـ in the past — that prefix belongs to the present only.

2 · كان + PRESENT = "USED TO"

Put كان in front of a present-tense verb (drop the بـ) and you get the habitual past — the tense of every childhood story:

كنت ألعب *kunt al3ab* I used to play · كنا نلعب *kunna nil3ab* we used to play · كانت تنادي *kaanat tnaadi* she would call.

Keep the بـ and it means something else: كنت بلعب *kunt bal3ab* — I was playing.

Dialect notes · continued

3 · كان MAKES ANY SENTENCE PAST

Palestinian has no present-tense "to be": أنا تعبان *ana ta3baan* — I'm tired. To put it in the past, just add كان:
كنت تعبان *kunt ta3baan* I was tired · كان في *kaan fee* there was · ما كان في *maa kaan fee* there wasn't · كان عندي *kaan 3indi* I had.

4 · A FEW LEVANTINE FALSE FRIENDS

WORD		
لبن	*laban*	yoghurt, not milk — milk is حليب
قهوة	*2ahwe*	coffee, and also the café itself
بس	*bass*	but / only / enough — from tone alone
يعني	*ya3ni*	"I mean", "sort of" — the great filler word
خلص	*5alas*	done, that's it, fine, stop

Where to go next. Re-read all three stories out loud back to back. Then try retelling story 3 in your own words in the past tense — that single exercise will do more for your fluency than another fifty vocabulary items.